

Abraham Gonzalez

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Education

University of California, Berkeley

August 2018 - August 2025

Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering and Computer Sciences, advised by Krste Asanović and Bora Nikolić, GPA: 3.96/4.0
Dissertation Title: “End-to-end Heterogeneous System Design for Hyperscale Big-Data Processing”

The University of Texas at Austin

August 2014 - May 2018

B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, GPA: 3.98/4.0

Job Experience

Software Engineer

October 2025 - Present

Google — Sunnyvale, CA

- Software engineer working in the [AI and Systems Research](#) group co-led by [David Culler](#) and [Hank Levy](#).

Graduate Student Researcher

August 2018 - August 2025

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Advised by Professor Emeritus and Professor of the Graduate School Krste Asanović and National Semiconductor Distinguished Professor Borivoje Nikolić.
- Ph.D. candidate and [ADEPT/Slice lab](#) member researching hyperscale cloud architectures, accelerator scheduling, and hardware design methodologies.
- Co-lead of the [Hyperscale system-on-chip \(SoC\) project](#) focused on hyperscale hardware/software co-design.
- Co-lead of the widely used [Chipyard SoC framework](#), which has been used in over 20 tape-outs at multiple academic institutions and has been used (not only cited) by over 150 peer-reviewed publications from first authors at over 65 companies and academic institutions.
- Co-lead of the award-winning [FireSim FPGA-accelerated simulation platform](#), which has been used (not only cited) in over 60 peer-reviewed publications from first authors at over 25 companies and academic institutions.
- Led the tape-out and bring-up of the first [Chipyard](#) test chip, a 106.1 GOPS/W heterogeneous multi-core multi-accelerator SoC made in Intel 22FFL.
- Developer of the [Berkeley Out-of-Order Machine \(BOOM\)](#), the first open-source Linux-booting synthesizable and parameterizable RV64GC RISC-V out-of-order core.
- [Published research](#) and [tape-outs](#) at top conferences including ISCA, DAC, IEEE MICRO, and ESSCIRC.
- Lead organizer for [over 10 tutorials and workshops](#) with over 200 unique attendees at top conferences.
- Mentored over 10 graduate and undergraduate students in hyperscale systems and hardware methodology research.

Student Researcher Intern

June 2021 - July 2024

Google — Sunnyvale, CA

- Student researcher working with Parthasarathy Ranganathan (Vice President and Engineering Fellow).
- Collaborated with the [SystemsResearch@Google \(SRG\)](#) and Systems Infrastructure Performance teams.
- Researched data processing and remote procedure call (RPC) optimizations as part of the [Hyperscale SoC project](#).
- Published research on [hyperscale big data processing characterization at ISCA '23](#).
- Open-sourced [HyperRPCBench](#), a novel representative RPC benchmark suite, with the [Fleetbench](#) team.

Silicon Engineering Group Intern

June 2020 - August 2020

Apple — Cupertino, CA

- Engineering intern working with Si-En Chang (Distinguished Engineer).
- Developed computer architecture tooling for CPU verification.

Scalable Performance CPU Development Group Intern

May 2018 - August 2018

Intel — Austin, TX

- Worked on debugging tools for the microcontroller integration team with senior engineers.
- Setup novel workflows and infrastructure between the firmware and microcontroller integration teams for agility.

Office Shared Graphics Explore Intern

May 2016 - August 2016

Microsoft — Redmond, WA

- Developed the proof-of-concept “Sketchy Lines” feature (now publicly available) in the Office suite using C++.
- Investigated and coordinated new feature sets with senior engineers, program managers, and customers.
- Created a synchronized network of Arduino microcontrollers using HTTP requests for the OneWeek hackathon.

UIM Driver Intern

May 2015 - August 2015

Qualcomm — San Diego, CA

- Designed a software framework for smartcard (UIM) interaction in C++/CLI and C++ with senior engineers.
- Integrated designed framework into a .NET application managing smartcards via CCID by utilizing APDU transmission/logging; file system viewing; file data parsing/manipulation; and smartcard reader management.
- Created gesture controlled car with Particle Core for the Hack-Mobile hackathon.

Graduate Research Experience

Hyperscale SoC Project

April 2019 - August 2025

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Co-lead of the Hyperscale SoC project focused on developing next-generation hyperscale computing.
- Focused on hyperscale big data processing platforms and RPC accelerator scheduling research.
- Combines the use of [Chippyard](#) and [FireSim](#) to explore new hardware/software co-design opportunities for big data processing platforms.
- Characterized three big data processing platforms (Spanner, BigTable, and BigQuery), running live-traffic at Google for the first time and [published the work at ISCA '23](#).
- Collaborated with the [Fleetbench](#) benchmarking team to open-source [HyperRPCBench](#), a novel representative synthetic RPC benchmark suite including payloads and a traffic driver.
- Built and correlated Python and C++ models for accelerator runtimes against x86 proof-of-concepts and [Chippyard](#)-based RTL running custom and [HyperRPCBench](#) payloads.

Chippyard: Agile RISC-V Hardware SoC Design Framework

April 2019 - August 2025

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Co-lead and core developer of [Chippyard](#), an integrated agile RISC-V SoC design, simulation, and implementation environment for specialized compute systems.
- Architected the main integration, build flow, and repository structure.
- Added support for multiple IPs including [BOOM](#), [SiFive blocks](#), [Ariane \(CVA6\)](#), [NVDLA](#), and more.
- Integrated the initial tape-out bring-up tether widget, FPGA bring-up flow, and software utilities.
- Added the initial CI/CD flow including torture/fuzz and distributed testing.
- Used in [over 20 tape-outs](#) at multiple academic institutions (such as Stanford and Technical University of Dresden).
- Used (not only cited) in [over 150 peer-reviewed publications](#) (spanning computer architecture, artificial intelligence (AI), systems, and more) from first authors at over 65 companies and academic institutions.
- [Over 650 unique forks and 1.8K stars on GitHub](#).

FireSim: FPGA-accelerated Hardware Simulation Platform

August 2018 - August 2025

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Co-lead and core developer of [FireSim](#), an FPGA-accelerated full-system hardware simulation platform with on-premises and cloud flexibility.
- Added FPGA-accelerated co-simulation with [Dromajo](#), enabling bug discovery billions of cycles into simulation.
- Re-architected the command-line interface and Python machine manager to support configurable custom clusters.
- Enabled larger simulations through local FPGA support with [U250/U280/U200](#) Xilinx UltraScale+ FPGAs and the [Xilinx Vitis Unified Software Platform](#).
- Expanded the initial CI/CD flow to include FPGA bitstream builds and simulations across local and cloud FPGAs.
- Used (not only cited) in [over 60 peer-reviewed publications](#) from first authors at over 25 companies and academic institutions in addition to being used in the development of commercial chips.
- Used as a [standard host platform for DARPA and IARPA programs](#), including in [DARPA's first ever bug bounty program \(FETT\)](#) to host novel security-augmented hardware designs on the internet for attack by 100s of white-hat hackers across the globe.
- [Over 200 unique forks and 900 stars on GitHub](#).

BEAGLE: Heterogeneous Multi-Core Multi-Accelerator Tape-out in Intel 22FFL

April 2019 - September 2021

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Led tape-out of the first [Chippyard](#) test chip, a 106.1 GOPS/W heterogeneous multi-core multi-accelerator test chip made in Intel 22FFL.
- Coordinated interaction between UC Berkeley and Intel during physical design process.
- Streamlined [Chippyard](#) vendor IP integration and custom boot flow.
- Led bring-up including open-sourcing newly created FPGA-based bring-up collateral.
- Led pre-silicon testing with large-scale [FireSim](#) simulations and automated [Chippyard](#) regressions.
- [Published working test chip at ESSCIRC '21](#).
- SoC Components: In-order Rocket core with a [Gemmini systolic array accelerator](#), out-of-order [BOOM](#) core with a [Hwacha](#) vector accelerator and runtime configurable non-speculative mode, shared L2, independent clock domains, and multiple IOs (GPIO, SPI, I2C, UART, SerDes).

- Developer of BOOM, the first open-source synthesizable Linux-booting RV64GC RISC-V out-of-order core.
- Added the initial CI/CD flow including torture/fuzz and distributed testing.
- Modified the RTL to support instantiation with other core IPs in addition to various quality-of-life improvements.
- Open-sourced and replicated Spectre speculative attacks on the core.

Skills

Programming Languages —

- *Highly Proficient:*
 - Traditional: Scala, C, C++, Python, RISC-V Assembly, Bash, C++/CLI
 - Hardware Description/Construction Languages (HDL/HCLs): Chisel, SystemVerilog, Verilog
 - Scripting and build systems: Make, CMake, Bazel, TCL
 - Machine Learning: TensorFlow, PyTorch
 - Other: SQL
- *Proficient:*
 - Traditional: ARM Assembly, LC-3 Assembly, Android Java, C#
 - Hardware Description/Construction Languages (HDL/HCLs): VHDL

Tooling — Tiva Launchpad, Arduino, SparkFun, Particle Core microcontrollers

Embedded Systems — Tiva Launchpad, Arduino, SparkFun, Particle Core microcontrollers

Electrical Equipment — Soldering, oscilloscopes, logic analyzers, multimeters

Other — Git, MapReduce, AWS, Google Cloud, Xilinx Virtex/UltraScale+ FPGAs, Cadence EDA tooling

Conference, Journal, Workshop, and Technical Report Publications

Summary (underline = first author or equal contribution)

arXiv '26, ISCA '24, ISCA '23, ESSCIRC '21, ISPASS '21, DAC '20 (invited), IEEE Micro 2020.4, CARRV '20, UC Berkeley Technical Report '20, CARRV '19

ArchAgent: Agentic AI-driven Computer Architecture Discovery

arXiv '26

Raghav Gupta, Akanksha Jain, Abraham Gonzalez, Alexander Novikov, Po-Sen Huang, Matej Balog, Marvin Eisenberger, Sergey Shirobokov, Ngan Vũ, Martin Dixon, Borivoje Nikolić, Parthasarathy Ranganathan, and Sagar Karandikar, “ArchAgent: Agentic AI-driven Computer Architecture Discovery”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.22425*, February 2026.

FireAxe: Partitioned FPGA-Accelerated Simulation of Large-Scale RTL Designs

ISCA '24

Joonho Whangbo, Edwin Lim, Chengyi Lux Zhang, Kevin Anderson, Abraham Gonzalez, Raghav Gupta, Nivedha Krishnakumar, Sagar Karandikar, Borivoje Nikolić, Yakun Sophia Shao, Krste Asanović, “FireAxe: Partitioned FPGA-Accelerated Simulation of Large-Scale RTL Designs”, *2024 ACM/IEEE 51st Annual International Symposium on Computer Architecture (ISCA)*, Buenos Aires, Argentina, June 2024.

Received all available artifact badges: Artifacts Available, Artifacts Evaluated: Functional, and Results Reproduced

Profiling Hyperscale Big Data Processing

ISCA '23

Abraham Gonzalez, Aasheesh Kolli, Samira Khan, Sihang Liu, Vidushi Dadu, Sagar Karandikar, Jichuan Chang, Krste Asanović, Parthasarathy Ranganathan, “Profiling Hyperscale Big Data Processing”, *2023 ACM/IEEE 51st Annual International Symposium on Computer Architecture (ISCA)*, Orlando, FL, USA, June 2023.

Received all available artifact badges: Artifacts Available, Artifacts Evaluated: Functional, and Results Reproduced

A 16mm² 106.1 GOPS/W Heterogeneous RISC-V Multi-Core Multi-Accelerator SoC in Low-Power 22nm FinFET

ESSCIRC '21

Abraham Gonzalez, Jerry Zhao, Ben Korpan, Hasan Genc, Colin Schmidt, John Wright, Ayan Biswas, Alon Amid, Farhana Sheikh, Anton Sorokin, Sirisha Kale, Mani Yalamanchi, Ramya Yarlagadda, Mark Flannigan, Larry Abramowitz, Elad Alon, Yakun Sophia Shao, Krste Asanović, and Bora Nikolić, “A 16mm² 106.1 GOPS/W Heterogeneous RISC-V Multi-Core Multi-Accelerator SoC in Low-Power 22nm FinFET”, *In proceedings of 2021 IEEE European Solid State Circuits Conference (ESSCIRC 2021)*, Virtual Event, September 2021.

COBRA: A Framework for Evaluating Compositions of Hardware Branch Predictors

ISPASS '21

Jerry Zhao, Abraham Gonzalez, Alon Amid, Sagar Karandikar, and Krste Asanović, “COBRA: A Framework for Evaluating Compositions of Hardware Branch Predictors”, *In proceedings of 2021 IEEE International Symposium on Performance Analysis of Systems and Software (ISPASS 2021)*, Virtual Event, March 2021.

Invited: Chipyard - An Integrated SoC Research and Implementation Environment DAC '20 (invited)

Alon Amid, David Biancolin, [Abraham Gonzalez](#), Daniel Grubb, Sagar Karandikar, Harrison Liew, Albert Magyar, Howard Mao, Albert Ou, Nathan Pemberton, Paul Rigge, Colin Schmidt, John Wright, Jerry Zhao, Yakun Sophia Shao, Krste Asanović, and Bora Nikolić, “Invited: Chipyard - An Integrated SoC Research and Implementation Environment”, *In proceedings of 57th ACM/IEEE Design Automation Conference (DAC 2020)*, San Francisco, CA, USA, July 2020.

Chipyard: Integrated Design, Simulation, and Implementation Framework for Custom SoCs

IEEE Micro 2020.4

Alon Amid, David Biancolin, [Abraham Gonzalez](#), Daniel Grubb, Sagar Karandikar, Harrison Liew, Albert Magyar, Howard Mao, Albert Ou, Nathan Pemberton, Paul Rigge, Colin Schmidt, John Wright, Jerry Zhao, Yakun Sophia Shao, Krste Asanović, and Bora Nikolić, “Chipyard: Integrated Design, Simulation, and Implementation Framework for Custom SoCs”, *IEEE Micro*, vol. 40, no. 4, pp. 10-21, (Special Issue on Agile and Open-Source Hardware), July-August 2020.

SonicBOOM: The 3rd Generation Berkeley Out-of-Order Machine

CARRV '20

Jerry Zhao, Ben Korpan, [Abraham Gonzalez](#), and Krste Asanović, “SonicBOOM: The 3rd Generation Berkeley Out-of-Order Machine”, *4th Workshop on Computer Architecture Research with RISC-V (CARRV 2020)*, Virtual Event, May 2020.

A Chipyard Comparison of NVDLA and Gemmini

UC Berkeley Technical Report '20

[Abraham Gonzalez](#), and Charles Hong, “A Chipyard Comparison of NVDLA and Gemmini”, *EECS Department*, University of California, Berkeley, May 2020.

Replicating and Mitigating Spectre Attacks on an Open Source RISC-V Microarchitecture

CARRV '19

[Abraham Gonzalez](#), Ben Korpan, Jerry Zhao, Ed Younis, and Krste Asanović, “Replicating and Mitigating Spectre Attacks on an Open Source RISC-V Microarchitecture”, *3rd Workshop on Computer Architecture Research with RISC-V (CARRV 2019)*, Phoenix, AZ, USA, June 2019.

Selected External Presentations

End-to-end Heterogeneous System Design for Hyperscale Big Data Processing

April 2025

Google — Sunnyvale, CA

End-to-end Heterogeneous System Design for Hyperscale Big Data Processing

April 2025

Apple — Cupertino, CA

Chipyard: An Open-Source RISC-V SoC Design Framework

April 2023

Latch-Up Conference — Santa Barbara, CA

FireSim: Fast and Effortless FPGA-accelerated Hardware Simulation with On-Prem and Cloud Flexibility

March 2023

Apple — Cupertino, CA

A 16mm² 106.1 GOPS/W Heterogeneous RISC-V Multi-Core Multi-Accelerator SoC in Low-Power 22nm FinFET

September 2021

ESSCIRC — Virtual

Chipyard: Integrated SoC Design, Simulation, Implementation Environment

July 2020

Apple — Virtual

End-to-End Architecture Exploration with RISC-V SoC Generators, FPGA-Accelerated Simulation and Agile Test Chips

December 2019

RISC-V Summit — San Jose, CA

Replicating and Mitigating Spectre Attacks on an Open Source RISC-V Microarchitecture

June 2019

CARRV — Phoenix, AZ

The Berkeley Out-of-Order Machine: An Open-Source Synthesizable High-Performance RISC-V Processor

May 2019

Latch-Up Conference — Portland, OR

Enhancing an Out-of-Order Processor Simulator for Cloud Applications

May 2018

Capstone Presentation at The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

A Machine Learning Approach to Modeling Electroplating Process Variations in IC Redistribution Layers

November 2017

Tutorials and Workshops Organized

Full-day Hands-on Tutorials on FireSim and Chippyard

MICRO '24, ISCA/ASPLOS/HPCA '23, ISCA/MICRO/ASPLOS '22, ISCA/MICRO '21, MICRO '19

Lead organizer presenting a series of full-day, hands-on tutorials on the Chippyard SoC framework and the FireSim FPGA-accelerated simulation platform at ten recent conferences, supported by the NSF-CCRI program, AWS, and Xilinx. Over 200 unique attendees were provided free AWS EC2 instances to customize RTL and boot large-scale simulations (e.g., booting Linux, running AI workloads, etc.) using Chippyard, FireSim, and cloud FPGAs.

First FireSim/Chippyard User and Developer Workshop

ASPLOS '23

Organizer of a full-day workshop consisting of 10 presentations from external users of the Chippyard SoC framework and the FireSim FPGA-accelerated simulation platform, discussions on feature development, and discussions on open-source governance of the platforms.

Undergraduate Research Experience

Enhancing an Out-of-Order Processor Simulator for Cloud Applications

January 2018 - May 2018

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

- Undergraduate researcher working under Professor Mattan Erez for the UT Austin capstone design course.
- Designed and developed new software data-structures for emulating simultaneous multithreading on ZSim.
- Built hardware scheduling policies ensuring quality of service for latency critical tasks in an out-of-order pipeline.
- Presented a poster of final results at The University of Texas Electrical Engineering Spring Open House.

Microsystems Technology Lab Intern

June 2017 - August 2017

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — Cambridge, MA

- Selected as one of 37 MIT Summer Research Program (MSRP) participants.
- Researched variations in electroplating growth in redistribution layers under Professor Duane Boning.
- Designed various neural networks and machine learning models for electroplating growth using Tensorflow.
- Awarded 2nd best research poster at the SHPE National Conference '17 for research presented.

Printing Electronics Research Assistant

January 2017 - June 2017

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

- Researched and fabricated printed antennas under the supervision of Professor Ray Chen.
- Printed and tested fixed phase array antennas on Kapton with various nano-particle inks.

QCA Research Assistant

May 2015 - August 2016

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

- Researched and designed quantum cellular automata (QCA) circuitry with Professor Earl Swartzlander.
- Optimized QCA implementations of the carry-lookahead and conditional sum adders through QCA Designer.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant - CS152/252A: Computer Architecture and Engineering

Spring 2023

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Taught one discussion section per week in addition to developing new homework, tests, and labs.

Head Teaching Assistant - EE290-2: Hardware for Machine Learning

Spring 2021

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA

- Taught one discussion section per week in addition to developing new homework, tests, and labs.

Teaching Assistant - EE460N/382N.1: Computer Architecture

Spring 2018

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

- Taught two discussion sections per week in addition to developing new homework, tests, and labs.

Tutor - Equal Opportunity in Engineering

Spring 2018

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX

- Assisted struggling students in electrical and computer engineering courses through tailored guides and lessons.

Professional Leadership and Extracurriculars

Member — Latinx Association of Graduate Students in Engineering and Science	Fall 2018 - Present
Member — Diversifying Future Leadership in the Professoriate (FLIP) Alliance	Fall 2018 - Present
Vice President — Eta Kappa Nu Electrical Engineering Honor Society	Fall 2017 - Spring 2018
Corresponding Secretary — Eta Kappa Nu Electrical Engineering Honor Society	Summer 2017 - Fall 2017
Member — Eta Kappa Nu Electrical Engineering Honor Society	Spring 2016 - Present
Member — Institute of Electrical and Electronic Engineers	Fall 2014 - Present
Member — Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE)	Fall 2014 - Present
Pi Tutor — Equal Opportunity in Engineering (EOE)	Fall 2015, Fall 2017
Academic Director — Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers	Summer 2016 - Summer 2017
Organizing Committee Member — 3 Day Startup Austin	Fall 2014 - Fall 2015
Participant — 3 Day Startup Austin	Fall 2014

Honors, Awards, and Selections

DARPA Riser — DARPA	Fall 2022
Analog Devices Outstanding Engineer Award — University of California, Berkeley	Spring 2020
EECS Excellence Award — University of California, Berkeley	Fall 2018
Berkeley Fellowship for Graduate Study — University of California, Berkeley	Fall 2018
GEM Fellowship Recipient — GEM	Spring 2018
Honorable Mention — NSF GRFP	Spring 2018
Highest Honors — The University of Texas at Austin	Spring 2018
Distinguished College Scholar — The University of Texas at Austin	Spring 2018
Academic Leader Hall of Fame Inductee — Equal Opportunity in Engineering Program	Spring 2018
Roberto Rocca Scholarship Recipient — Tenaris	Fall 2017
Second-Place Award Winner — SHPE National Conference Poster Competition	Fall 2017
Distinguished College Scholar — The University of Texas at Austin	Spring 2017
Victor L. Hand Scholarship Recipient — Victor L. Hand Endowed Scholarship Fund	Fall 2016
College Scholar — The University of Texas at Austin	Spring 2016
Diversity Scholarship Recipient — Texas Instruments	Fall 2015
Freshman Academic Excellence Award Winner — EOE and SHPE	Spring 2015
Qualcomm DECA Attendee - selected as 1 of 51 nationally — Qualcomm	Spring 2015
LEAD Conference Attendee - selected as 1 of 30 nationally — LEAD	Summer 2013

References

Krste Asanović
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University of California, Berkeley
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University of California, Berkeley
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Sophia Shao
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